

credit without which business hardly could exist, but more of personal debts.

Having some money laid away is a means of avoiding the uncertainty and often the embarrassment that goes with incurring a personal debt. But saving does more for you than merely make it possible to spend the money you save. Saving gives you the habit of gauging your money against your needs. It helps to remind you that money is good only because of what it can buy in goods and services, and again it helps you gauge what you need in the way of goods and services.

The habit of saving does away with the habit of waste. As saving becomes a need, through habit, many a man finds he can live just as well as he did before, on the same salary, and this even if some prices have gone up. Why is this? Because he stops throwing away portions of his money on needless or frivolous items; he buys more carefully; he conserves his clothing and other possessions. He finds out how to make his money do its absolute most for him. And he does not do this by forcing himself into poverty for the sake of building his bank account. He continues to live at his general level and finds he can save as well.

What should you do with the money you save? There is no single answer that fits everyone.

I have seen and heard of a good many instances in which small saved sums—in one case as little as two hundred dollars—were used as investments in small businesses of good promise. Some of these investments paid back many thousand per cent. Of course you cannot count on this, but bear in mind that an opportunity arose and a person who had saved was able to take advantage of that opportunity without borrowing, without obligating himself.

A young couple had formed the habit of buying "on time." They were always in debt. One day the wife calculated the amount they had paid out in interest and said, *Never again!* The couple was about to give a party and needed a new bridge table with four matching chairs. But the wife said they would play bridge sitting on the rug—and incur no more debts. They called it Turkish Bridge and had a hilarious good time.

This experience caused them to put aside some friends who seemed unable to entertain without making a show, and cultivate friends who valued friendship more than display—friends who turned out to be far more worth knowing. Also